# FRANKLIN CHENG

San Jose, CA **(OPEN TO RELOCATION)** | (646) 858-7167 | franklin_cheng@outlook.com | LinkedIn | Portfolio

## EDUCATION

**M. S. in Human Factors and Ergonomics** (UX Conc.), San Jose State University — August 2024 - Spring 2027
*CGPA: 3.95 / 4.0*

**B. A. in Anthropology (Hons.)**, New York University — September 2021 - May 2023
*Howard Levene (WSC '41) Research Scholar & Dean's Undergraduate Research Fund Grant*

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

***Product Design Intern,*** The Kroger Co., Cincinnati, OH — May 2026 - August 2026

- Led the onboarding experience for Kroger's enterprise item management platform by designing a three-layer learning support framework for 10 role-specific user groups, enabling adoption of a mission-critical merchandising and supply chain system
- Collaborated with 4 Senior Product Designers and 5 Product Managers to define the platform's onboarding strategy, presenting the vision and implementation roadmap to 50+ cross-functional stakeholders to drive alignment across product, engineering, and business teams
- Designed two end-to-end enterprise workflows in Figma using Kroger's component-based design system, simplifying complex item management processes and improving operational efficiency
- Designed and implemented a role-aware AI onboarding assistant by developing custom prompts, knowledge context, and reusable AI skills, reducing support dependency and delivering personalized guidance during migration from legacy systems
- Conducted mixed-method UX research—including **journey mapping**, **contextual inquiry**, **interviews**, and **focus groups**—with 10+ user groups, synthesizing insights into actionable onboarding requirements that addressed workflow pain points and role-specific needs

***Strategic Support Fellow,*** Wilmington Learning Collaborative, Wilmington, DE — June 2025 - August 2025

- Led a mixed-methods study of 18 citywide summer learning programs, assessing offerings, participation trends, and systemic challenges through **program observations**, **semi-structured interviews**, and **surveys**
- Synthesized findings into actionable insights for a statewide education strategy, presenting recommendations directly to the mayor, senators, and education leaders across multiple school districts in DE and PA; research findings were later featured on a statewide news channel
- Designed evaluation timelines, benchmarks, and KPIs to guide $1.5M in summer learning funding, supporting long-term measurement of academic ROI for the Wilmington Learning Collaborative

***User Study Moderator***, Apple Inc., Cupertino, CA — January 2025 - June 2025

- Led and supported usability studies, collaborating cross-functionally with researchers, project managers, and operations teams to identify user pain points and improve product experience
- Conducted **user interviews**, **usability testing**, and **data collection setup**, ensuring methodological rigor and high-quality insights
- Managed end-to-end data collection, from participant recruitment and informed consent to supervising sessions, safeguarding confidential data, and reviewing datasets for quality assurance and reporting

***User Experience Consultant***, dfusion Inc., Remote — October 2024 - January 2025

- Conducted UX research—including **heuristic evaluation**, **usability testing**, and **semi-structured interviews**—to identify key user pain points and inefficiencies in the user flow of an EdTech solution designed to gamify math learning for middle school students
- Designed wireframes, mockups, and interactive prototypes for the core dashboards and student-facing interfaces—now launched across 10 school districts nationwide
- Initiated competitor research to identify trends and gaps in supplementary educational curricula, reaching out to local public school districts to understand classroom needs and inform product development

## ENTREPRENEURIAL PROJECT

***Hao's House (Home Bakery)*** – Owner — August 2023 - Present

- Built a community of 500+ loyal customers on various social media platforms, resulting in $2,000+ average monthly sales with a 90% customer return rate while balancing full-time studies and another part-time job

## SKILLS

*Research*: Project Management, Research Operations, Usability Evaluation, Interviews, Ethnography, Surveys, Metrics Design
*Leadership & Collaboration*: Empathy, Active Listening, Stakeholder Management & Communication, Agile Collaboration
*Tools:* SPSS, MAXQDA, Figma, Mural, Miro, Notion, Confluence, Qualtrics, Adobe Creative Suite, Microsoft Office Suite